

Sambhav Daffu

sambhav.daffu@thinkdigit.com

What do you get when you add a 3G connection and a curious geek like yourself? For one, it seems like the perfect recipe for a local social superstar! As a Digit geek, you would have been approached with tech queries; and we're quite sure you must have provided some tech *gyaan* for good measure, in addition to the solution. Wouldn't it be great if that girl next door you've been sharing shy awkward glances with, came up to you and asked if you know a good sizzler joint in town? We hope you won't curl up into a ball and timidly go back to the comfort of your beloved computer.

Crowdsourcing as we all know, is the coming together of individuals with similar interests and collaborate on ideas on the internet for the greater good of the community. A good example is Wikipedia. Local crowdsourcing is a scaled down, localised version of it where people from the same area share interests and

useful information so that other users in the vicinity can make the most of the local deals. With the advent of 3G, this trend has picked up pace and is bound to grow even further. 3G has not only made surfing the internet on the go much faster, but also enhanced the uploading speeds. Users can now upload information, pictures and reviews seamlessly which is a corner stone of local crowdsourcing. Integration of ideas and opinions makes local crowdsourcing services a useful hub for users to share and disseminate information. In the west, the local crowdsourcing trend has made great inroads with new services and mobile apps mushrooming everyday. India is still at a nascent stage as we lack high smartphone market penetration and 3G mobile coverage.

While there may not be many people using 3G phones and services in our country, there is a hoard of data being uploaded by users everyday. According to Pankaj Chaddah, co-founder of Zomato.com, a service that depends on such data, "crowd sourcing faces the drawback of a lot of junk data being

generated by users and we need to moderate it. With the arrival of 3G, we certainly think that social media apps will get a huge boost here too."

Food services

Essentially a restaurant listing web service, Zomato is also one of the first Indian web sites to launch an Android app for its local listings. Formerly known as Foodiebay, Zomato currently has over 11,000 restaurants registered with it. Using the Zomato Android app, users can upload pictures and reviews of food and restaurants. What's unique about the app is that 'users get to view the menu of the restaurant, navigational maps and reviews uploaded by other users in three simple steps' says Chaddah. You can rank the ambience, service and other factors on a scale of 5 using the app. If you don't have an Android phone, you can also visit its mobile version.

Foodspotting.com is a location-based service where users upload the image of the food they spot in certain parts of the city. This helps other foodies

You + 3G = local social superstar

Leverage the power of local crowdsourcing in your area

